

WEEK - 6

Understanding the Structure of an Email

Video 1: Structure and Purpose of Emails

Why Should We Write Formal Emails?

- Seeking information, providing information, and acknowledging the receipt of information
- Lodging a complaint and responding to a complaint

Structure of Email

- Subject line
 - Brief and precise
 - Convey the particular idea/concern
- Opening salutation
- Self- introduction
- Problem statement
- Explanation and closure
- Closing salutation

Video 2: Tone and Politeness in Emails

- Tone and Its Significance in Writing Emails
 - Tone refers to the "voice" that communicates the attitude of the author
 - The right tone helps the recipient perceive the meaning of the message the sender intends to convey
 - Since non-verbal cues are missing in emails, it is important to maintain the right tone while writing emails

Factors That Determine the Tone of Emails

- Target recipient
 - The tone depends on the recipient of the email

Email	Tone	Example
Professional	Formal	Peers
Personal	Informal	Friends

- Recipient's comprehension
 - How the recipient is expected to comprehend and interpret an email.
- Message type
 - The tone depends on the type of message to be conveyed.
 - Example: The tone of an email with a personal invitation to a wedding will be different from the tone of an official email sent to a co-worker.

Politeness in Emails

- Significance of politeness in emails
 - Important to maintain politeness
 - Reflects respect and consideration toward the recipient
 - Required for effective communication
- Politeness markers
 - Please
 - Could you please
 - Best regards
 - If you don't mind
 - Thank you

Video 3: Email Language

Email Language

- Language should be courteous and non-judgmental
- Use of words should reflect politeness
- Language should be clear and precise
- Use of emoticons should be avoided in formal emails
- Discretion needs to be maintained in using interjections
- Proper punctuation is necessary

Types of Email Language

- Informal emails
 - Hey
 - Cool
 - No prob
 - Hope things are fine
- Formal emails
 - I am writing to you to finalize the plan as discussed in our last meeting.
 - According to our customer care policy, we will initiate the refund right after the order is canceled.
 - May I ask for an appointment to meet you on Tuesday?
- Replying to formal emails
 - Thanks for the update
 - Thanks for the prompt response
 - Thanks for attending the lecture
- Emails offering an apology
 - Please accept our sincere apologies.
 - I apologize for the inconvenience caused.
 - Sorry for the delay in replying.
- Emails with requests
 - I would really appreciate it if you could give us your valuable feedback.
 - Could you please let us know when the project begins?
 - I will be grateful if you could write a recommendation letter for me.
- Emails with attachments
 - Please find attached the report for your reference.
 - Please have a look at the attached file.
 - I have attached the question paper for your review.

Email Etiquettes

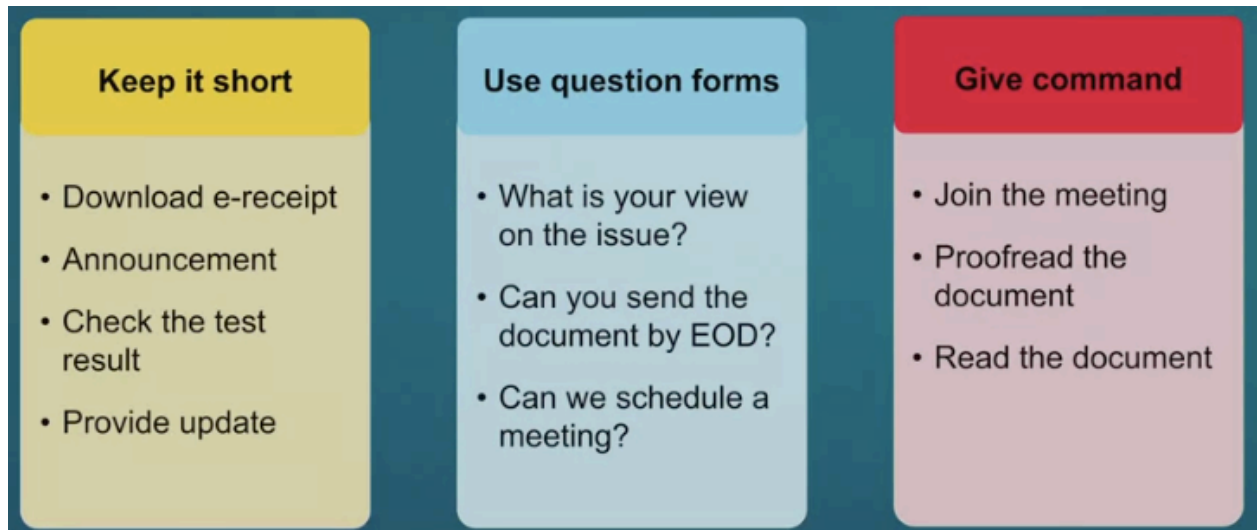
- Spellings should be correct
- For formal emails, there should be proper salutation
- Message should be clear and concise
- Unnecessary use of carbon copy (CC) should be avoided
- Unnecessarily replying to all should be avoided
- Use of all capital letters should be avoided

Video 4: Email Subject Line

What Is Subject Line? Why Is It Important?

- The subject line is one sentence or few words summary of the content written in an email
- Draw the reader's attention
- Helps the readers decide to read or ignore the email

Strategies to Write Subject Line



Video subtitle:-

“Then when you design or draft a sudden a subject line, so what are the things you should always keep in your mind? The very first important thing when you draft your subject line is that you need to keep it short. Because again, the thing we need to consider, the people are busy with lots of other things, so their inbox might be just flooded with several emails. So your subject lines should be very short and just giving him and how an idea what it is about. Download e-receipt. Something like that when you're providing certain attachment. Or you can simply write announcement. Then the email would say further what is the announcement that you are writing to him or her. Check the test results. Something very primary, just keeping the minimal world and design it like that, so it is very short and the person doesn't have to take a lot of time when he or she is reading the subject line, or something like provide update. The email will talk about the update, what you are going to share or express in your email. Then you can also sometimes use question form. Which also in a way creates certain curiosity of your email. Because you are putting suppose a subject line like what is your view on the issue. The person who's receiving that email, he or she can open that email, and then you could get to the core of your email what is the key concern you are representing or writing to him or her. Or something like, can you send the document by EOD? Something like that, I'm just giving you an instance. The email also represents a concern, and sometimes looking at the subject line, the person also gets an idea what the email's asking him or her to do, so he or she can take immediate measure depending on the queries or questions you have. Or can we schedule a meeting, so immediately

the person is getting that an idea, and what the email may be, perhaps so talk about schedule when an onward concern or something like that. Or sometimes, you can also give commands. Not always, but depending on who is the recipient, what message you're appealing to convey, so you can write, like join the meeting. The sub idea is also sometimes there an already a discussion, there's already an email trade where the meeting detail has already been shared. Simply giving a command to your subject line, like join the meeting or something like that, or proofread the document. That's already an idea being established to what documents you are going to discuss or shared, and the person is also getting that thing in your attachment, so just proofread the document or read the document. Something like that. But the idea is very minimally in a way you are designing or drafting, so the person is getting an idea of what this email is about. These are some useful strategies to write a good and proper subject lines.”

What to Avoid?

- Avoid lengthy subject line
- Do not shout or capitalize words unnecessarily
- Do not overuse emojis
- Do not write misleading subject line

Video 5: Opening Salutation in Emails

Professional Email Salutation

- Salutation helps address the people
- It indicates your relationship with the receiver of the email
- Incorrect use of salutation can lead to "misgendering"
- Selecting the appropriate salutation is important in professional email communication

Formal Salutation

Use	When
Dear Sir/Madam	Do not know the name of the recipient
Dear Mr. Kamal/Ms. Kamal	Know the gender of the recipient (avoid using "Mrs." in professional communication)
Dear Dr. Praneetha	Address a medical practitioner or a PhD holder
Dear Harpreet Kaur	Do not know the gender of the recipient
To Whom It May Concern	Writing to an institution

Less Formal (Not Informal) Salutation

Use	When
Dear colleagues,	Communicating with the whole group
Dear Rubin,	Know the recipient and want to be less formal
Dear Zareena,	Know the recipient and want to be less formal

Video 6: Self-Introduction and Problem or Purpose Statement in Emails

Self-Introduction in an Email

- Briefly introduce yourself in one or two sentences.
- Mention your name and how you are related to or relevant to the recipient.
- You may also include your role in your organization, such as student or job title.

Examples:

I am Krithi Sen Gupta, and I am currently a student of BSc Computer Science at BITS. recently read your research paper on Big-data-as-a-service.

I am Bharat Mukherjee, Associate Software Engineer at ABC IT Solutions. We briefly discussed the services offered by our company over the phone yesterday.

Stating the Problem or Purpose

- Provide details on "why" you are writing the email.
- Concisely state your problem or purpose.
- Mention what you hope to achieve by writing this email.

Example:

I am writing to enquire about applying to the Diploma program in Cloud Computing offered at your university. I was hoping to get some more details about the course structure. Could you please send me a detailed description of the course?

Some Points to Keep in Mind

- Ensure that the language used is formal and polite.
- Use one or two paragraphs.
- Use simple language to explain the problem or purpose.
- Use bullets or a numbered list for multiple problems or purposes.

Example:

Thank you for writing back to me about the document verification process. It would be really helpful if you could offer some clarification for the following questions.

1. What are the documents that need to submit for the verification process?
2. Is it possible to complete the verification process online?

Video 7: Explanation and Closure in Emails

Why Explanation?

- After stating the problem or purpose, further explanation may be required.
- The explanation may answer questions like what, why, where, when, or how.
- A mistake or misunderstanding, acknowledge your own contribution and take appropriate responsibility.

Example:

It appears that the mix up was due to a typographical error that I made in the document. Please find the updated information in the document attached below. Sorry for the inconvenience caused.

Closure

- Thank the recipient for their time or for any help they may have provided.
- If there is a deadline or time period for the recipient to respond, mention it clearly.
- Reference any subsequent interactions you hope to have with the recipient.

Example:

Please send in the relevant documents as a reply to this email by the end of the day. Thank you for your time. Feel free to reach out to me by phone for any clarifications you may need.

Video 8: Closing Salutation in Emails

Closing Salutation

- After the explanation and closure of the email, a use a closing salutation like regards, sincerely, best, respectfully, etc.
- Closing salutations make your email sound professional and polite.
- After the salutation, mention your full name, position or title, organization, and contact information like phone number or email address.
- If you are writing on behalf of a company or organization, you may also need to add its logo

Example

Thanking you,
Raju Srivastava,
Software Developer, FYV
Software Solutions Pvt. Ltd.
rajusrivastava20@fyvsolutions.co.in
Ph: 0123456789



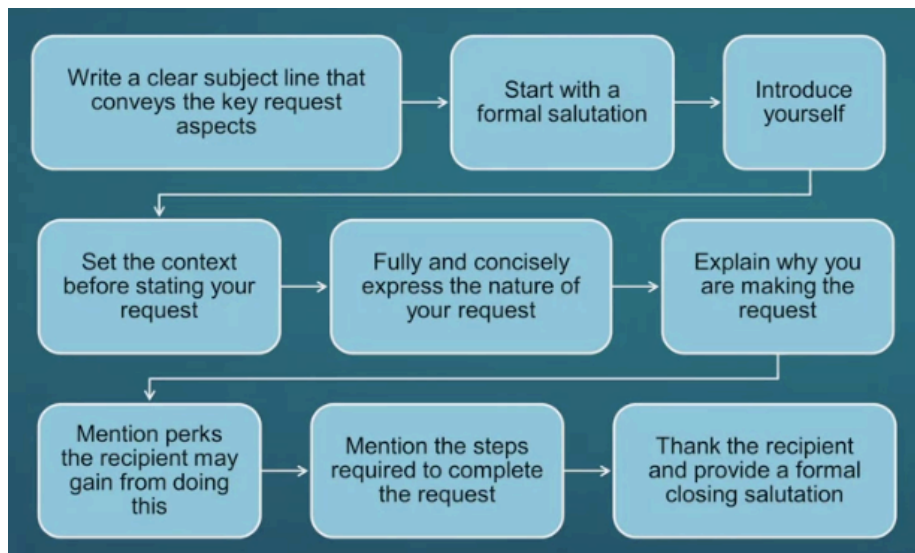
Composing Formal Emails for Various Academic Purposes

Video 1: Email of Request

Purpose of Writing an Email of Request

- Make a professional request in a formal yet easy manner
- Seek professional help from an expert in the field
- Ask for resources or documents for your work or research
- Record requests made so that appropriate follow-up is possible
- Seek permission or signature on documents to superiors in the organization
- Seek participation or presence in an event you are organizing

Email of Request: Structure



Example

To: adrianchris@abcuniversity.edu

Subject: Request for reading suggestions

Hello Dr. Adrian Chris,

I am Ritwik K, pursuing my third year of BSc Computer Science at ABC University. I am attempting a project on traffic monitoring using computer vision. I was inspired by the guest lecture that you gave on this topic. Could you please suggest some books or articles in this area of research for me to read? I would highly appreciate any recommendations that you can give me. Looking forward to hearing from you.

Thanking you,

Ritwik K,

BSc Computer Science, ABC University.



Video subtitle:-

“So the first thing which is very important is to write a clear subject line that conveys the key aspects of your request. So start with a formal salutation which is important there in every email, so which is important here in email of request as well. So introduce yourself if you haven't done so already. So who you are, what is your concern, what kind of company or collaboration or team you are part of, and that would automatically lead the email in a certain way and the person will get an idea why you're interested in certain kinds of resources or research work or result of information what you are seeking a kind of help with that particular person. So before stating your request, you may set a commendation of the recipient after earlier work to set the context because it gives more clarity in that way. Fully express the nature of your request in a kind of a concise manner. So there shouldn't be any kind of a complexity or it shouldn't be very vague. It should be very clear this is where you're coming from, this is what you want and this is what you are looking forward to. So you'll be very specific when you are writing the email of requests, particularly this part of email of request. And then maybe sometimes it's better when you explain why you were making that request. So maybe sometimes it would appear that you are really interested in certain kind of research works and kind of collaborative work but you actually don't have access to that kind of material. So because you may not have access to certain kind of a library, certain kinds of data set, certain kinds of resources. So you just explain why you are making that request. So again, we should clarify certain kind of project which we should clarify the way you are making that request and which also make the request a serious kind of request. So mention perks the recipient may gain from doing this. Sometimes we also request certain kind of participant or collaborator for certain help for certain kinds of suggestions, certain kind of resources. And maybe you can also offer if these things work, we can think about a collaboration after a certain point of time. So you can also give that idea in a certain way which would also make the proposal more interesting, more lucrative in certain ways which may or may not. Like you have to think about the situation what the recipient, what kind of recipient you're like structuring your email of request to. And then mention the steps that may be taken to complete the request so that again the clarity part is very important here. So you are also clearly mentioning the steps in a way so that the person is getting an idea what exactly we're looking forward to and how he or she could respond to that particular request. And at the end of your email of request, you thank the recipient and provide a formal closing salutation which would make your email of request even more polite and more proper in that way. So you are also thanking at the end, you can also say thank you or you can say thank you in advance or something like that which would make your email a serious kind of an email and also which would indicate that you are a polite and serious person who is having that particular request to the recipient.”

Video 2: Complaint Email

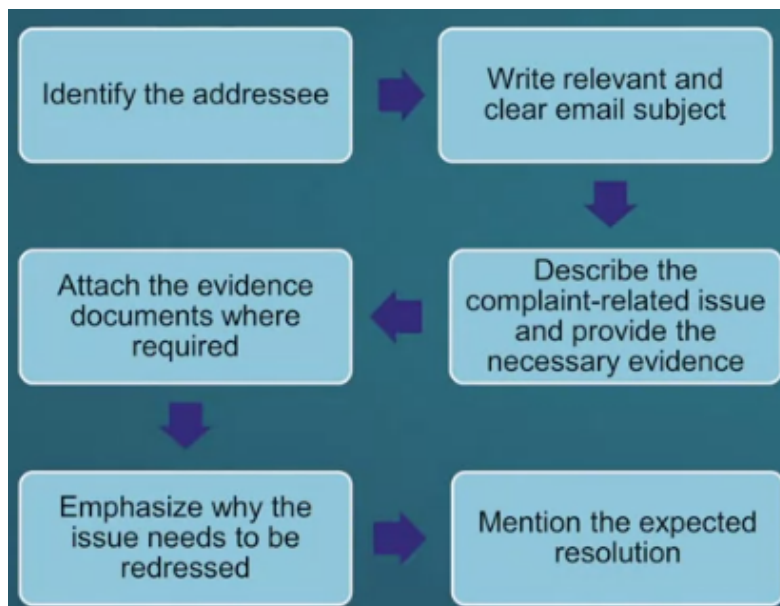
Complaint Email

- A type of business email written with the hope for a grievance to be redressed.
- Although written often for unpleasant reasons, it must be written carefully.
- Maintain discretion regarding using words
- Include formal, courteous, non-judgmental, and non-discriminatory words.

Types of Complaint Emails

- Customers
 - Customers (individuals or an organization) have product-related complaints addressed to the seller for undelivered or faulty products.
- Users
 - Users of services have service-related complaints to be resolved by the service providers.
- Administration of organizations
 - Administrations of different organizations often raise complaints to different service providers.
- Individual complaints
 - Other than business-related issues, individuals write to different government or nongovernment organizations for redressal of grievances.

Steps to Write Complaint Emails



Video subtitle:-

“So then, next coming to the, next part of the complaint mail, which is the steps to write complaint email. So the addressee should be identified first. Is it ideal to identify a specific addressee? It's very important because the complaint is directed towards someone, right? So you should be very careful to whom you're writing. So you need to be very careful to who may or may not be accountable for certain kinds of grievances which you are like feeling or you're expressing your concern. So be very, very careful when you decide on that. So sending an email to someone who cannot address the issue reduce the chance of address. So it's also not helping your cause, because if you're writing to someone else who is not in charge, then the purpose is not going to solve, it's not going to help you at the end, right? So be very careful when you decide the addressee of your complaint email. Then the subject of email should be related to a complaint and should be clearly written, very precise, very brief, but clearly giving an idea what this complaint is about. The complaint related issues should be described with clarity providing evidence to support the complaints. So, you cannot just complaints and the kinds of things, but you also should come from something kind of a ground which would substantiate the complaint you have. So it should help the recipient also get a better idea what are the things you are complaining about, the documents with evidences should be at touch with the email where required. So, something kind of written documents, like a scanned copy of written documents, sometimes the screenshots kind of things. Depending on what is the nature of your complaint email, you're supposed to and expected to provide certain set of attachments which would make the complaint more clear, more serious. So if the complaint is not redressed, the complaint can further write emails emphasizing on why the issue needs to be redressed, so you can also write that. The sender might also mention in the email that resolution they expect, so sometimes to make the action more prompt. The person who is receiving your email he or she can take a prompt like action or like response, so that for why like you're writing that email, that purpose is serve.”

Example of a Complaint Email

Dear (Title),

This is a complaint regarding a steam vaporizer I purchased on (date) from your online selling platform. I placed the order through your shopping app. received the product today, and I can see that a defective product has been delivered to me. A nozzle is missing from the vaporizer.

I have made an opening video of the product. Please find the attached video herewith.

I would like to return the product and would expect you to initiate a refund.

Looking forward to hearing from you soon.

Thank You,

(Name of the sender)

Video 3: Response to a Complaint Email

Responding to Complaint Emails

The service provider or the customer care executive should:

- Acknowledge the customer's frustration
- Be sympathetic toward the customer who sends a complaint email
- Address the complaint in a professional manner
- Thank the customer for reaching out and assure them of the issue redressal
- Consider offering a discount to the customer on the further purchase if that is within your authority.

Sentences Commonly Used to Reply to Complaint Emails

- Thank you for reaching out to us
- We are sorry for the experience you had with our service
- I am sorry to hear about the complaint
- We are sorry for the inconvenience caused
- We are proud that you chose us as the service provider
- Your complaint will be addressed at the earliest

Example of Reply to Complaint Email

Dear (Name),

Thank you for reaching out to us. Customer satisfaction is our first priority. We apologize for the damaged product that has been delivered to you. We would like to let you know that we appreciate your feedback.

We assure you that the damaged product will be replaced.

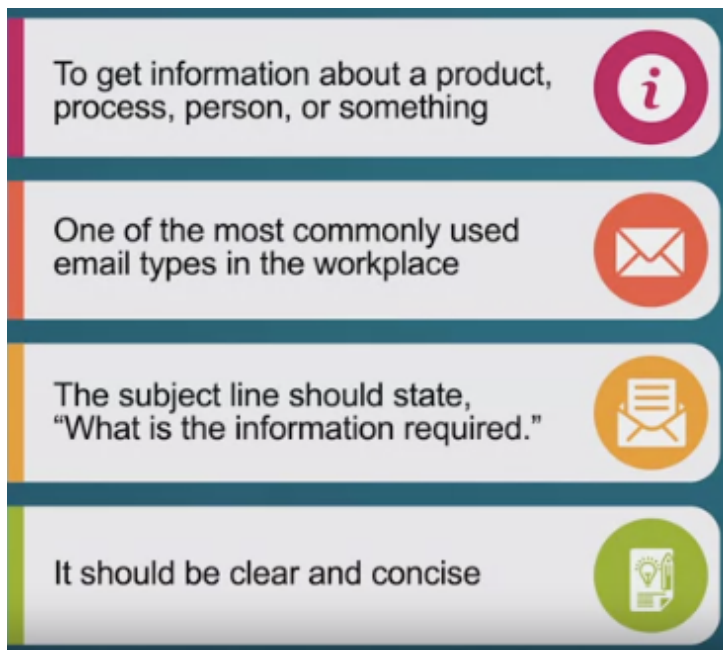
We genuinely apologize for the inconvenience caused. We hope to offer you better service in future.

Please let us know if you have any further query.

Thank You,
(Name of the customer care executive)

Video 4: Enquiry Email

Enquiry Email



Structure of an Enquiry Email

Salutation	Formal salutation Example: Dear Madam/Sir,
First	State the purpose clearly Example: I visited your website for pearl ornaments and would like to know your store address in Kochi.
Second	Introduce yourself (only if it is necessary) Example: I am a trader from Cuttack.
Third	Ask for additional information if required Example: It will be great if you could also send your e-catalog to this email id.
Closing	Thank and politely remind about the request Example: Thank you. I look forward to receive the information and e-catalog.

Sample Enquiry Email

From: XXXXX@gmail.com

To: XXXXX@line.in

Subject: Request for a price quotation. a

Dear Madam/Sir,

We request you for a price quotation for 36X24X30 inch office table. We are a medium-sized engineering company in New Delhi. We would like to buy 50 office tables

with chairs for our new office. In addition, please mention the transport and fitting charges in the quotation. We are looking forward to receive your price quotation.

Thank you.

Regards,

XXXXX

HR

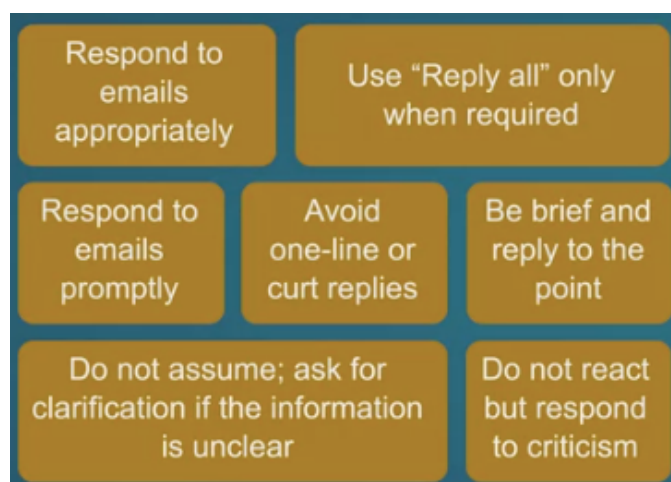
ENO Engineering, New Delhi

Video 5: Email Etiquette

Email Etiquette: While Drafting an Email

- Use a professional subject line
- Use appropriate tone and be aware of intercultural differences
- Double-check your recipient's addresses
- Keep relevant stakeholders in the CC
- Use a professional email ID
- Use a professional signature
Name, title, designation, and contact details
- Use standard fonts

Email Etiquette: While Replying to an Email



Video subtitles :

“Then coming to the second part, which is the email etiquette, you should keep in mind while you are replying to an email. You get an email from a professional body or an organization, from your collaborator, from your teammates or your supervisor and you are replying or responding to that particular email. You respond that email appropriately. Use, Reply all, only when required. You need to be very careful whether you need to reply all or you need to just reapply the person who has returned to you or like you can give some other person in CC, that depending on what requirement is there, you need to take a decision and then you need to draft your email properly. Then respond to an email promptly possible so that a person doesn't have to wait for a long period to get a response from your side and always avoid one-line reply. Again, which might be indicative of you're like not so seriously, you are looking or engaged looking at are they engaging with the matter. You be very brief and reply to the point, but don't write one-word response as yes, no, or something like that to the email, so at least spend some time to draft a one full sentence, couple of sentences, and then respond with that. Don't assume, ask for clarification. If the email you get certain part of the email is clear to you, but you're not getting the entire concern or the questions being asked, and you shouldn't assume the remaining part rather, you just ask for clarification. You can always say, thank you for email, but this is the part which, could you elaborate a little more? Or something like that just to get a better clarity rather than you assuming on his or her behalf. Sometimes the email could have certain criticisms, certain of a complain, so you shouldn't react to that, but you can always respond to that criticism and what is your response if someone is having or showing certain criticism.”

General Email Etiquettes

- Use professional greetings
- Organize your points
- Avoid using too many abbreviations
- Avoid using inappropriate emojis and symbols
- Avoid humor that might be culturally inappropriate
- Avoid forwarding or attaching irrelevant information
- Value the recipient's time
- Proofread your emails
- Check if your attachments are enclosed before sending

Video subtitle:-

“. General email etiquette is like you always use professional greetings, organize your points, so structure your email properly before you are sending to that email. Avoid using too many abbreviations, which again doesn't look very serious, proper, and professional, so you should always avoid that. Avoid using inappropriate emojis and symbols in your email, which would make it very confusing and complicated and vague. You should never do that. Also avoid humor that might be culturally inappropriate. You should be very professional in your tone and overall, the structure of the email, so you should follow these guidelines. Avoid also forwarding or attaching irrelevant information. Just the things which it was asked or which you just want to convey or want to express, you just stick to those points rather than adding a

lot many things which is not serving the purpose. Value the recipient's time. You're not adding a lot of information, you are just respectful to his or her time and you're structuring your email accordingly. If possible, proofread your email. Because sometimes when you're writing an email, certain things are there which we are not taking care of. When you're proofreading your email, you're reading it second or third time, you will be observing certain things which are not written in a proper way, and also sometimes there could be spelling mistakes. You should very careful when you proofread and then you proofread your mail and then finally you can send your email. Then check if your attachments are enclosed before sending because sometimes we write, please find attached, but there is no attachment along with that email. You should be very careful that your attachments are properly there, and then only you can send your email to the recipient you are planning to send.”